

**THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS**

**PMGM7011
Creative Global Management Solving**

GENERAL INFORMATION

Instructor: Prof. Chun Hui, 許濬, 许濬
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Consultation times: Thursday 10am -12 pm

Tutor: TBD

Pre-requisites: None

Co-requisites: None

Mutually exclusive: N/A

Course Website: Moodle

Required Business Cases and Textbooks:

1. Intel in China. Ivey Publishing: 99C007.
2. The Chatty Accusation at the Customer Support Call Center. Darden Business Publishing. U of Virginia. UV6865
3. Nordstrom: Dissension in the Ranks (A). Harvard Business School. 9-191-002.
4. Acer, Inc.: Taiwan's Rampaging Dragon. Harvard Business School. 9-399-010.
5. Toys "R" Us Japan. (Harvard Business School case 796-077).
6. Lincoln Electric. (Harvard Business School case: 9-398-095).

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course examines analytically and critically current problems in global management. It will address multiple employee and organizational problems that students would find beneficial to have exposures to. This course adopts a problem analytical approach to examining and understanding issues selected. Issues include tools of creative problem solving, diversity, visions, motivation systems, team building and challenges for change. This course serves to develop analytic, critical thinking, problem solving, and presentation skills that will contribute directly to effective global business management.

Instead of a theory-driven course, this course is predominantly case based. Business cases provide rich contextual information on leadership problems. Students are expected to read the assigned cases before classes. Lectures will include active participation from students and guidance and analyses by the instructor. Theories and concepts will be introduced in the contexts of the problems being analyzed.

COURSE OBJECTIVES		
1. Develop critical thinking and creative problem solving skills 2. Learn theories and concepts of creative problem solving and global management issues 3. Apply critical thinking and creative problem solving skills to global management issues 4. Demonstrate effective communication and presentation skills		
PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES		
PLO1: Acquisition and internalization of knowledge of the programme discipline PLO2: Application and integration of knowledge PLO3: Inculcating professionalism and leadership PLO4: Developing global outlook PLO5: Mastering communication skills		
COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES		
Course Learning Outcomes	Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes	
CLO1. Demonstrate critical thinking when presented with global management issues and express their views and opinions on these issues in an articulate way. CLO2. Identify relevant theories and concepts for analyzing and solving particular global management problems. CLO3. Conduct topic and case analysis to apply learnt concepts and skills. CLO4. Demonstrate effective communication and presentation skills.	PLO1; PLO2 PLO1; PLO2; PLO3 PLO1; PLO2; PLO3 PLO4	
COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES		
Course Teaching and Learning Activities	Expected contact hour	Study Load (% of study)
<<examples>>		
T&L1. Interactive lectures	30	25%
T&L2. Business scenarios/Role play preparation	30	25%
T&L3. In-class discussion reports	10	8.4%
T&L4. Group Case analysis and presentations	25	20.8%
T&L5. Individual paper	25	20.8%
Total	120	100%

Assessment Methods	Brief Description (Optional)	Weight	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes
A1. Individual Attendance and Participation	Attendance & discussions. Discussion and practice questions will be provided to encourage a group and individual student to participate in discussions and exchange views. Attendance will be taken for the lectures. The attendance and individual sharing in class will be considered in assigning points for attendance and individual participation. All MGM students have to attain a minimum attendance requirement of 70% for each course.	20%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4
A2. Individual Paper	Each student will be required to submit a final individual paper based on topics covered in this course, or a topic relevant to creative problem solving. Students will select a problem that they would like to solve, analyse the problem and provide solutions. The problem can be based on a business case or information collected by the student. Students may also use one of the cases adopted in this course and demonstrate effective creative problem solving of this case. Students are expected to knowledge gained from this course in addressing the selected problem. Due: 1 week after last lecture; October 14, 12 a.m. Maximum six (6) pages of text, type written professional report in Times New Roman 12 and <u>double spacing</u>. • Content of the report – 70% • Style (writing and presentation) – 30% • Submit the file in WORD format • Filename: surname-other names-student number • E.g. Chan-Tai-Man-11011111	40%	CLO1, 2, 3
A3. Group Project	Students are expected to form a maximum of 10 groups of similar size. They are required to identify a problem situation in an enterprise of their choice, critically analyze the problem and generate solutions based on creative problem-solving methodologies. The problem can be based on a business case or information collected by the group.	40%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4

	• Gain knowledge of problems employees would encounter and how we may analyze and solve these problems • Choose the problem and the organization that interests your group the most • Source can be a business case, information in the media or from personal contacts • You may select a case from Harvard Business Press • https://hbsp.harvard.edu/home/ In the project: • Identify a management problem that an organization actually encounters • Analyze why the problem occurs • Examine what the organization has done • Suggest solutions to the problem • Demonstrate creativity problem solving in the process Each group is required to make a 25-30 minutes presentation (including Q&A) and submits both a HARD COPY and a SOFT COPY of the presentation file. • At least 4 members or close to majority of the group should present • Again, submit both hardcopy and softcopy of slides before presentation • No written report required • Due: A day before first presentation date • A: 9: 30 a.m. Oct 2 • B: 2:00 p.m. Oct 2 The group presentation and group report will be evaluated based on the five criteria (i.e., presentation style, content coverage, articulation on critical issues, use		
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	of concepts taught in class, quality of interaction at the Q&A session, and the content of the report).		
	Total	100%	
STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT			
Course Grade Descriptors			
A+, A, A-	• Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions professionally • High participation in discussions • Present arguments that have an element of originality • Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the exams with very accurate computation and very good analytical and problem solving skills • Excellent performance in assignments		
B+, B, B-	• Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions in a logical way • Good participation in discussions • Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook • Achieve a standard of good performance in the exams with accurate computation and good analytical and problem solving skills • Good performance in assignments		
C+, C, C-	• Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Fairly address questions as set • Some participation in discussions • Present arguments in a well-structure manner • Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the exams with reasonably accurate computation and acceptable analytical and problem solving skills • Acceptable performance in assignments		
D+, D	• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Barely address questions as set • Minimal or no participation in discussions • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the exams with some errors in computation and barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills • Marginally acceptable performance in assignments		
F	• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Unable or unwilling to handle questions • Minimal or no participation in discussions • Present arguments poorly • Fail to meet a standard of passing the exams with major errors in computation and inadequate analytical and problem solving skills • Poorly performance in assignments		
Assessment Rubrics for Participation			
A+, A, A-	• High participation in discussions • Always attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions professionally • Present arguments that have an element of originality • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)		
B+, B, B-	• Good participation in discussions • Often attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions in a logical way • Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)		

C+, C, C-	• Some participation in discussions • Sometimes attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Fairly address questions as set • Present arguments in a well-structure manner • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
D+, D	• Minimal or no participation in discussions • Rarely attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Barely address questions as set • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
F	• Minimal or no participation in discussions • Almost never attend in-class discussions • Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Unable or unwilling to handle questions • Present arguments poorly • Behave poorly in class (often chatting with others, using cell phones, or being late)

Assessment Rubrics for Assignments

A+, A, A-	• Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge • Present arguments that have an element of originality • Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the assessments with very accurate computation and very good analytical and problem solving skills
B+, B, B-	• Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook • Achieve a standard of good performance in the assessments with accurate computation and good analytical and problem solving skills
C+, C, C-	• Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments in a well-structure manner • Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the assessments with reasonably accurate computation and acceptable analytical and problem solving skills
D+, D	• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the assessments with some errors in computation and barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills
F	• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments poorly • Fail to meet a standard of passing the assessments with major errors in computation and inadequate analytical and problem solving skills

COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE

Sessions	Modules	TOPICS / Cases
Sessions 1-3	Fundamentals of Creative Problem Solving	
Session 1 A: Sep 3 9:30 CP-EFG B: Sep 3 2:00 CP- EFG	<i>Topic 1: Introduction</i>	<i>Introduction</i> ▪ Why important? ▪ What is creativity? ▪ What is problem solving?

Session 2 A: Sep 6 9:30 CP- EFG B: Sep 6 2:00 CP- EFG	Topic 2: Creative Problem Solving Basics 1	<i>Basics of Creative Problem Solving I</i> ▪ <i>The Tze-kun problem: What is the problem? What are creative solutions?</i> ▪ <i>Fishbone</i> ▪ <i>Force Field</i> ▪ <i>Improve Problem Definition</i> ▪ <i>Improve Generation of Alternatives</i>
Session 3 A: Sep 10 9:30 CP- EFG B: Sep 10 2:00 CP- EFG	Topic 3: Creative Problem Solving Basics 2	<i>Basics of Creative Problem Solving II</i> ▪ <i>Jobs and the Bankrupting Apple</i> ▪ <i>Context, Contents, People</i> ▪ <i>Creative Problem Solving is about Elegant Simplicity</i>
Sessions 4-8	Creative Problem Solving Methodology in Application	
Session 4 A: Sep 13 9:30 CP- EFG B: Sep 13 2:00 CP- EFG	Topic 4: Supervisor- subordinate Problems	<i>Expatriates versus Locals</i> ▪ <i>Supervisor Philosophy and Style</i> ▪ <i>Subordinate Concerns</i> ▪ <i>Case: Intel in China. Ivey Publishing: 99C007</i>
Session 5 A: Sep 24 9:30 CP- EFG B: Sep 24 2:00 CP-EFG	Topic 5: Teammate Problems	<i>Conflicts in cross-cultural teams</i> ▪ <i>Cultural differences?</i> ▪ <i>Case: The Chatty Accusation at the Customer Support Call Center. Darden Business Publishing. U of Virginia. UV6865</i>
Session 6 A: Sep 27 9:30 CP- EFG B: Sep 27 2:00 CP- EFG	Topic 6: Motivation Problems	<i>How to Motivate Employees to Treat the Job as Theirs when They are Employed</i> ▪ <i>What is Service?</i> ▪ <i>Motivating Service at Individual and System Levels</i> ▪ <i>Case: Nordstrom: Dissension in the Ranks (A). Harvard Business School. 9-191-002</i>
Session 7 A: Oct 4 9:30 CP- EFG B: Oct 4 2:00 CP- EFG	Topic 7: The No Solution Problem	<i>When You Do Not Have the Solution, Where and How to Find It?</i> ▪ <i>Building an Organization: Strategy, Vision,</i> ▪ <i>People, Values, Culture</i> ▪ <i>How it Worked</i> ▪ <i>Case: Acer, Inc.: Taiwan's Rampaging Dragon. Harvard Business School. 9-399-010</i>

Session 8 A: Oct 5 9:30 CP-EFG B: Oct 5 2:00 CP- EFG	<i>Topic 8: Simple and Not So Simple Solutions</i>	<i>When you see challenges versus opportunities – what to do?</i> ▪ <i>What can you do when you see ‘unsurmountable’ challenges?</i> ▪ <i>What can you do when you see threats but opportunities?</i> ▪ <i>Case 1: Toys “R” Us Japan. (Harvard Business School case 796-077)</i> ▪ <i>Case 2: Lincoln Electric. (Harvard Business School case: 9-398-095)</i>
Session 9 A: Oct 8 9:30 CP- EFG B: Oct 3 2:00 CP-EFG	Group Project Presentation (I)	
Session 10 A: Oct 15 9:30 CP- EFG B: Oct 15 2:00 CP- EFG	Group Project Presentation (II)	

RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS

1. Gary, L. Want Better Results? Boost Your Problem-solving Power. Harvard Management Update. Article Reprint No. U0410A.
2. Satell, G. (January, 2018). Why the Rewards for Ambitious Problem Solving are About to Get Bigger. Harvard Business Review.
3. Beard, A. (May-June, 2018). Drunk People Are Better at Creative Problem Solving.
4. Badaracco, J.L. Jr. (2007). Drill Down: Problem Solving Strategies for Quiet Leaders. Harvard Business Review.
5. Excerpted from Leading Quietly: An Unorthodox Guide to Doing the Right Thing. Harvard Business School.
6. Some Aspects of Problem-solving and Conflict Resolution in Management Groups. Harvard Business Press. 9-479-003.
7. Javidan, M., Teagarden, M., & Bowen, D. (April, 2010). Making it Overseas. Harvard Business Review.
8. Wetlaufer, S. (January-February, 1999). Organizing for empowerment: An Interview with AES's Roger Sant and Dennis Bakke. Harvard Business Review.
9. Tapies, J., & Ceja, L. (2013). Tips to Foster Ownership in your Organization. Harvard Business Press.
10. Note on Organizational Culture. Stanford Graduate School of Business. Case: OB-69.
11. Tushman, M.L., O'Reilly, C.A.III. (2007). Shaping Organizational Culture. In Winning Through Innovation: A Practical Guide to Leading Organizational Change and Renewal. Harvard Business School Publishing.

MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

- ☐ Online response via Moodle site
- ☐ Others: SFTL (please specify)

COURSE POLICY (e.g. plagiarism, academic honesty, attendance, etc.)

An orderly learning environment is extremely important for this course. Disruptive behaviors are absolutely unacceptable. Academic dishonesty includes cheating, plagiarism, unauthorized collaboration, falsifying academic records, and any act designed to avoid participating honestly in the learning process. Any such dishonesty will result in an F grade.

ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION (e.g. e-learning platforms & materials, penalty for late assignments, etc.)
No late assignment will be accepted. Lecture notes and self-learning materials will be uploaded on Moodle. Good questions and discussions on Moodle will be awarded participation grades.